

CHARGE IT TO THE CROSS AND LET THE BLOOD SETTLE IT

* POWER POINT SLIDES

** INSTRUCTIONS TO TECHNICIAN

TEXT: 1 Corinthians 1:18 (NIV) *“For the preaching of the cross is to them that perish foolishness; but unto us which are saved it is the power of God.”*

INTRO: As a boy growing up in northwestern Arkansas there were a number of old sayings that I became accustomed to hearing. I grew up hearing the old adage, *“Charge it to the dust, and let the rain settle it.”*

When someone was approached about a debt that they knew they couldn't possibly pay, they would say, *“Charge it to the dust, and let the rain settle it.”* While sleeping, the Lord gave me a sermon based on this old adage and I want to entitle it, Charge it to the cross, and let the blood settle it. (Some of the best sermons I ever preached I preached in my sleep – Some of the best sermons I ever preached I preached in some other peoples sleep between 11 & 12 on a Sunday morning!)

First of all let me say the death, burial, and resurrection of Jesus is the central theme of the Word of God. The death of Christ is directly mentioned 175 times in the New Testament.

The Cross and the Christ of the cross are represented as one, because they are eternally connected. The Apostle Paul writing in his first letter to the Corinthian Church sets forward the preaching of the cross as being of paramount importance in the carrying out of the Great Commission! 1 Corinthians 1:18 *“For the preaching of the cross is to them that perish foolishness; but unto us which are saved it is the power of God.”*

To the Jews, the Cross was a tree of shame and horror. According to the Jews, a person who was wicked enough or unfortunate enough to be crucified was ***“accursed of God.”*** This belief was based on a scripture in Deuteronomy 21:23 ***“... he that is hanged is accursed of God...”*** Galatians 3:13 ***“Christ hath redeemed us from the curse of the law, being made a curse for us; for it is written, Cursed is every one that hangeth on a tree.”***

To the Greeks, the cross was the gallows-style execution of a slave’s infamy and a murderer’s punishment. Historically, there was not a single association connected with the cross except those of shame and agony! Where our culture glamorizes the cross, displaying it décor in churches, homes and places of business as well as wearing it as jewelry, the very thought of a crucified messiah seemed to the Jews a revolting if not blasphemous idea.

They expected their messiah to mount a charger and enter Jerusalem as a King. This is precisely why an entire nation and system of religion missed their moment! Our world has glamorized the cross to the point that it is nothing more than a religious symbol or another piece of décor or jewelry, while missing the whole point and person of the cross.

The worship of a crucified malefactor seemed to the Greeks a detestable superstition.

The crucifixion of Christ was carried out in an era when public opinion of people who died the death of the cross was at such an all-time low. It was against this backdrop that the Apostle Paul came preaching to the Corinthian Church – ***“Jesus Christ (The Jewish Messiah), and him crucified.”***

This is partially why Paul attracted the bitter persecution from the religious establishment. It is rather obvious that Paul was not seeking popularity or even immediate success. If he had been, he would have

preached something to this Church other than the cross. The results of this message on the subject of the cross, proved his doing and undoing!

As unpopular as this message was, **the very cross that Paul preached became the recognized badge of Christianity. The symbol of the cross is universal. (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE.)** Three centuries later the cross was woven in gold upon the banners and set in jewels on the diadems of the Roman Empire.

I want to tell you today, after so many centuries have come and gone, the preaching of the cross has not lost one ounce of its potency, influence, or ability to turn one around and send him/her in a new direction. *“It reaches to the highest mountain and it flows to the lowest valley!”* **To preach the cross is not enough, we must also preach Christ crucified. (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)** The wood in the cross could not save a mosquito but the blood that ran down it’s frame can save the world!

To glory in the cross is to glory in that grace which, through, death, has put away sin and slain the enmity of the human heart. Ephesians 2:11-20 *“Therefore remember that you, once Gentiles in the flesh—who are called Uncircumcision by what is called the Circumcision made in the flesh by hands—¹²that at that time you were without Christ, being aliens from the commonwealth of Israel and strangers from the covenants of promise, having no hope and without God in the world.¹³But now in Christ Jesus you who once were far off have been brought near by the blood of Christ. ¹⁴For He Himself is our peace, who has made both one, and has broken down the middle wall of separation, ¹⁵having abolished in His flesh the enmity, that is, the law of commandments contained in ordinances, so as to create in Himself one new man from the two, thus making peace, ¹⁶and that He might reconcile them both to God in one body through the cross, thereby putting to death the enmity. ¹⁷And He came and preached peace to you who were afar off and to those who were near. ¹⁸For through Him we both have access by one Spirit to the Father. ¹⁹Now, therefore, you are*

no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of the household of God.”

The death of the cross: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Spells in capital letters the death of sin as a barrier in man's way to God
- Makes God accessible to every human being
- Creates level ground for every human being
- Spells in capital letters the end of death as the wages of sin
- Completely delivers those who cling to the sacrifice of the old rugged cross

On that great day in Israel when the High Priest made the annual atonement for the sins of the people, he sprinkled with the blood of the sacrifice all the vessels of the Tabernacle. This single act signified that the way was now opened up for the entering into the enjoyment of all the blessings that they represent.

Through the sprinkling of the blood of atonement, all the things typically set forth in the Tabernacle were freely offered to the people:

- Jew and Greek
- Bond and free
- Male and female
- Circumcised and uncircumcised
- Red-yellow-black-and-white
- The haves and the have-not's

So we read in Romans 8:32 ***“He that spared not his own Son, but delivered him up for us all, how shall he not with him also freely give us all things?”*** Through His sacrifice He is attempting to give us all things that pertain to life and godliness. Why do we resist? (Try to give away \$100 in \$10 bills)

He is saying to us here that all things needed to live a consecrated, victorious, overcoming, Christian life, have been provided through the avenue of the cross. In other words, whatever we have need of, we have the authority to charge it to the cross and let the blood settle it.

It was to his own disciples that Jesus said: Matthew 7:7-11 (NKJV) ***“Ask, and it shall be given you; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you; For everyone that asketh receiveth and he that seeketh findeth and to him that knocketh it shall be opened. Or what man is there of you, whom if his son ask bread, will he give him a stone? Or if he ask a fish, will he give him a serpent? If ye then being evil know how to give good gifts unto your children, how much more shall your Father which is in heaven give good things to them that ask him?”***

Over the next three weeks I want us to look at **three things that I believe His cross has provided that we could not have received any other way:**
(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- The sinner can charge his sin to the cross and when the blood settles the sin question, he becomes a saint
- Those who are estranged from God can charge the reason for their estrangement to the cross and when the blood reconciles the differences, they have fellowship with God
- Those who are in turmoil can charge their panic to the cross and when the blood has done its perfect work, there will be peace

I. THE SINNER CAN CHARGE HIS/HER SIN TO THE CROSS

Colossians 2 :13-14 (NKJV) ***“And you, being dead in your trespasses and the uncircumcision of your flesh, He has made alive together with Him, having forgiven you all trespasses, ¹⁴having wiped out the handwriting of requirements that was against us, which was contrary to us. And He has taken it out of the way, having nailed it to the cross.”*** (ILLUSTRATE THIS)

(YOU HAVE BEEN GIVEN A CARD TO WRITE ON AND I INVITE YOU AT ANY TIME DURING this SERMON TO COME UP HERE & GET A HAMMER & NAIL & NAIL ANY ISSUE YOU WANT TO THE CROSS – A SIN – A HEALTH ISSUE – A FINANCIAL DILEMMA – ETC)

One can charge his sin to the cross and when the blood settles it, he/she has become a saint.

Everyone is either the recipient of being saved or the victim of perishing. What does it mean to be perishing?

This terrible word “perish” means:

- To decay...
- To be lost...
- To destroy utterly...
- To lose utterly...
- To lose eternal life...
- To be spiritually destitute...
- To be cut off...
- To be dying...
- To deteriorate ...
- To be without hope...

Perishing means to be in a lost state in this world. Perishing means to be in a lost state in the world to come. It means:

“Live once, die twice. Die once, live twice.” (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)

The thing about sin is this:

- Sin separates one from the presence of God, both here and in eternity...

- One can never hide a thing from God – The secret of every heart will be revealed...
- One's sin will eventually be judged by a righteous God...
- Sin always separates one from family both now and in eternity...

What can you do about your sin problem? **Charge it to the cross and let the blood settle it! (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)** If you are perishing and it seems you are going down for the last time, charge it to the cross and let the blood settle it.

Just as Paul uses the word perish, he also uses the word saved. In the Greek, both words are continuous action. This means that a person is either perishing or being saved; the words are not static; we are not sitting still.

We must accept the fact that each of us are either perishing, more and more. Being gripped by the flesh, and being conditioned to accept a perishing, dying, disintegrating world! Or we are being saved, more and more. We are being freed to walk righteously and living Godly in this present world. ***“The path of the just is as a shining light, and it grows brighter and brighter day by day.”***

The person who is saved is being conditioned to break loose from a perishing, dying, disintegrating world, and is looking for the glorious appearing of a new and improved world! The continuous condition of salvation is an experience that is occurring right now.

Every day I am charging my sins to the cross and allowing the blood to settle all my sin issues. This is not a permanent deposit but a constant dependence. **We are not containers; we are conduits. (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)**

Do I ever have a problem charging my sins to the cross and allowing the blood to settle my sin debt? Absolutely, but I have come to the

realization that this continuous condition of salvation is a description of the work of the Holy Spirit, day by day in my life.

(JESUS WALKS ONTO STAGE AND STARTS PAINTING ALL THE PAPERS NAILED TO THE CROSS WITH RED PAINT – DO CLOSE UPS WITH CAMERA AND PLACE ON ALL THREE SCREENS – LEAVE THIS UP THE REMAINDER OF THE SERVICE)

Romans 6:14 “*For sin shall not have dominion over you: for ye are not under the law, but under grace.*”

Romans 8:2 “*For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus hath made me free from the law of sin and death.*”

Phillipians 1:19 “*For I know that this shall turn to my salvation through your prayer, and the supply of the Spirit of Jesus Christ.*”

Why is it that some are saved while yet others perish? The answer is those who are saved have charged their sin problem to the cross; the blood has settled the sin question, now we are saints saved by grace.

The Hemphill's made popular a song some years ago that states pretty well the process of charging our sin problem to the cross, allowing the blood to settle the sin question, and allowing us to become the saints Jesus meant us to be. The song goes like this: “*I’m not perfect, just forgiven, haven’t arrived but I’m on my way. Since Jesus saved me and forgave me, can’t say I’m perfect but I can say I’m saved.*” Why don’t you charge it to the cross and let the blood settle it today?

II. THOSE WHO ARE ESTRANGED FROM GOD CAN CHARGE THE REASON FOR THEIR ESTRANGEMENT TO THE CROSS

One of the greatest tragedies of our time is the estrangement that has been introduced into this culture: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Parents estranged from children..
- Children estranged from parents...
- Parents estranged from each other...
- Friends estranged from one another...

The high rate of divorce is emotionally crippling a generation of people! There was a time in this country when two people married and had several children. Now, two people get married have a child who ends up having several parents!

After more than three decades of Pastoral Ministry, and countless counseling sessions, I have come to the conclusion that divorce is a fate far worse than death! (Divorce recovery classes – What do we say?)

When a person loses a companion through death, there is a tremendous sense of loss, and enough grief to last for a lifetime. However, in a divorce one still has the residue of loss and grief, but added to those emotions there is rejection! Estrangement is bitterly hostile when thrust upon the emotional makeup of mankind! Mankind was not created with a mechanism to deal with estrangement because God never intended for such a thing to be introduced into the mix of mere mortals.

God recognized the bitter devastation of rejection that occurs when there is estrangement in a relationship and He speaks through the Prophet Isaiah, and say's to Israel, Isaiah 50:1-2 (KJV) ***“Thus saith the LORD, Where is the bill of your mother’s divorcement, who I have put away? or which of my creditors is to whom I have sold you? Behold, for your iniquities have ye sold yourselves, and for your transgressions is your mother put away. (2) Wherefore, when I came, was there no man? when I called, was there none to answer? Is my hand shortened at all, that is cannot redeem? Or have I no power to deliver? behold, at my rebuke I dry up the sea, I make the rivers a wilderness: their fish stinketh, because there is no water, and dieth for thirst.”***

Think of this: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- With estrangement, comes separation...
- With separation comes an inability to communicate...
- With the lack of communication comes misunderstanding...
- Misunderstanding leads to unwarranted feelings of hostility...
- Hostility leads to hatred...
- Hatred produces irreconcilable differences...
- Irreconcilable differences are the reason given for most divorces...

ILLUSTRATION: Woman in a Sunday morning service in AR who had planned a double murder...

I want to challenge us to bundle up our estrangement; separation; lack of communication; misunderstandings; unwarranted feelings of hostility; hatred; irreconcilable differences, and charge it to the cross and allow the blood to settle all the issues!

The Word of God has much more to say about reconciliation than it does about estrangement. The word reconcile means to conciliate, which means to win over or to make a friend.

Who is qualified for reconciliation? **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- **Husbands and Wives!** 1 Corinthians 7:10-11 (KJV) *“And unto the married I command, yet not I, but the Lord, Let not the wife depart from her husband: (11) But and if she depart, let her remain unmarried, or be reconciled to her husband: and let not the husband put away his wife.”* I’m convinced that there is not a problem that exists among marriage partners, that if each of them would charge the reason for their estrangement to the cross, the blood would produce reconciliation!
- **Christians!** Matthew 5:22-26 (KJV) *“But I say unto you, That whosoever is angry with his brother without a cause shall be in danger of the judgment: and whosoever shall say to his brother,*

Raca (Worthless), shall be in danger of the council: but whosoever shall say, Thou fool, shall be in danger of hell fire. (23) Therefore if thou bring thy gift to the altar, and there rememberest that thy brother hath ought against thee; (24) Leave there thy gift before the altar, and go thy way; first be reconciled to thy brother, and then come and offer thy gift. (25) Agree with thine adversary quickly, whiles thou art in the way with him; lest at any time the adversary deliver thee to the judge, and the judge deliver thee to the officer, and thou be cast into prison. (26) Verily I say unto thee, Thou shalt by no means come out thence, till thou hast paid the uttermost farthing.” If we have a problem with a brother or sister we should charge it to the cross and allow the blood to settle it!

- **The world!** 2 Corinthians 5:17-20 (KJV) *“Therefore if any man be in Christ, he is a new creature: old things are passed away; behold, all things are become new. (18) And all things are of God, who hath reconciled us to himself by Jesus Christ, and hath given to us the ministry of reconciliation; (19) To wit, that God was in Christ, reconciling the world unto himself, not imputing their trespasses unto them; and hath committed unto us the word of reconciliation (20) Now then we are ambassadors for Christ, as though God did beseech you by us: we pray you in Christ’s stead, be ye reconciled to God.”* Charge it to the cross and let the blood settle it!

The result of reconciliation is fellowship! 1 John 1:3-7 (KJV) *“That which we have seen and heard declare we unto you, that ye also may have fellowship with us: and truly our fellowship is with the Father, and with his Son Jesus Christ. (4) And these things write we unto you, that our joy may be full. (5) This then is the message which we have heard of him, and declare unto you, that God is light, and in him is no darkness at all. (6) If we say that we have fellowship with him, and walk in darkness, we lie, and do not the truth: (7) But if we walk in the light, as he is in the light, we have fellowship one with another, and the blood of Jesus Christ his Son cleanseth us from all sin.”*

When there is reconciliation in a marriage there should be fellowship in that marriage! (The best part of fussing is making up!)

What does fellowship in a marriage involve? Spending time together! Doing things together; just the two of you! Ephesians 5:22-23 (KJV)

“Wives, submit yourselves unto your own husbands, as unto the Lord. (23) For the husband is the head of the wife, even as Christ is the head of the church: and he is the savior of the body. (24) Therefore as the church is subject unto Christ, so let the wives be to their own husbands in every thing. (25) Husbands, love your wives, even as Christ also loved the church, and gave himself for it; (26) That he might sanctify and cleanse it with the washing of water by the word, (27) That he might present it to himself a glorious church, not having spot, or wrinkle, or any such thing; but that it should be hold and without blemish. (28) So ought men to love their wives as their own bodies. He that loveth his wife loveth himself. (29) For no man ever yet hated his own flesh; but nourisheth and cherisheth it, even as the Lord the church: (30) For we are members of his body, of his flesh, and of his bones. (31) For this cause shall a man leave his father and mother, and shall be joined unto his wife, and they two shall be one flesh. (32) This is a great mystery: but I speak concerning Christ and the church. (33) Nevertheless let every one of you in particular so love his wife even as himself; and the wife see that she reverence her husband.” 1 Corinthians 7:3-5 (KJV) ***“Let the husband render unto the wife due benevolence: and likewise also the wife unto the husband. (4) The wife hath not power of her own body, but the husband: and likewise also the husband hath not power of his own body, but the wife. (5) Defraud ye not one the other, except it be with consent for a time, that ye may give yourselves to fasting and prayer; and come together again, that Satan tempt you not for your lack of self-restraint.”***

If you are having problems in your marriage, charge it to the cross and let the blood settle it!

When there is reconciliation in the body of Christ it should produce fellowship! 1 John 3, 7 (KJV) ***“That which we have seen and heard declare we unto you, that ye also may have fellowship with us: and truly our fellowship is with the Father, and with his Son Jesus Christ. (7) But if we walk in the light, as he is in the light, we have fellowship one with another, and the blood of Jesus Christ his Son cleanseth us from all sin.”***

Some people avoid the fellowship of other Christians like the plague then stay bent out of shape wondering why they don't fit in! A family I pastored in another District left the church because they just could not get connected or seem to make friends; the really upsetting part of this episode was that they always came late and left early, never taking advantage of any social events planned for the purpose of building relationships! (Life Groups)

Whatever is keeping us from experiencing the fellowship of other Christians, is also keeping us from being everything we can be for God! Leviticus 26:8 (KJV) ***“And five of you shall chase an hundred, and an hundred of you shall put ten thousand to flight: and your enemies shall fall before you by the sword.”*** Five believers will have a one to twenty ratio but one hundred believers will have a one to one hundred ratio! (Illustrate this) (My experience at the Independence Bowl)

Charge it to the cross and let the blood settle it! You need us and we need you!

When we become reconciled to God, we have fellowship with God! **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE END OF THE SERVICE)** 1 John 1:3,6 (KJV) ***“That which we have seen and heard declare we unto you, that ye also may have fellowship with us: and truly our fellowship is with the Father, and with his Son Jesus Christ. (6) If we say that we have fellowship with him, and walk in darkness, we lie, and do not the truth.”***

Whatever is keeping us from our fellowship with God, is robbing us of the greatest opportunity ever afforded to man! We must, charge it to the cross and let the blood settle it!

III. THOSE WHO ARE IN TURMOIL CAN CHARGE THE REASON FOR THEIR PANIC TO THE CROSS, THERE WILL BE PEACE!

Our world is full of worry and panic! Terror is a driving force behind:

- Governmental decisions...
- Wars and rumors of wars...
- The sluggish economy...
- The lifestyles of the rich and famous...
- The lifestyles of the not so rich and famous...

Listen to how Paul describes the look of the last days. 2 Timothy 3:1-5 (NKJV) ***“But know this, that in the last days perilous times will come:***
²For men will be lovers of themselves, lovers of money, boasters, proud, blasphemers, disobedient to parents, unthankful, unholy,
³unloving, unforgiving, slanderers, without self-control, brutal, despisers of good, ⁴traitors, headstrong, haughty, lovers of pleasure rather than lovers of God, ⁵having a form of godliness but denying its power. And from such people turn away!”

In this culture, it seems people everywhere are panic stricken. Jesus himself predicted the last days would be a time identifiably marked by tremendous Fear! Luke 21:25-26 (KJV) ***“And there shall be signs in the sun, and the moon, and the stars; and upon earth distress of nations, with perplexity; the sea and the waves roaring; (26) Men’s hearts failing them for fear, and for looking after those things which are coming on the earth: for the powers of heaven shall be shaken.”***

The surge of terrorism coupled with the ability of the news media to not only report such instances but to show graphic pictures has led to a particularly heightened state of fear among the populous of this world.

Terrorism is no new thing. **Terrorists have been on the earth for as long**

as sinful man has populated this globe:

- Terrorists in the home
- Terrorists in the workplace
- Terrorists in the church

Though there have always been terrorists in our world, the new wave of terrorism is different because it marks the initiation of the birth pangs of the end times. The fear that has gripped the hearts of the people in this culture has brought with it a wave of panic and worry that seems to eclipse all barriers including age, race, sex, and socio economic status.

What are people so fearful and panic stricken about? Thomas S. Kepler tells of a group of 104 psychologists who determined a **timetable for anxiety: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- At age 18, people worry about ideals
- At age 20, they worry about their appearance
- At age 23, they worry about morals
- At age 26, they worry about making good impressions
- At age 30, they worry about their salary, and the cost of living
- At age 31 they worry about success in their business or career
- At age 33, they worry about job security
- At age 41, they worry about politics
- At age 42, they worry about marital problems
- At age 45 they worry about loss of ambition
- When one is over 45, the major concern becomes health related

Some people worry because they have nothing to worry about!

I grew up eating eggs not realizing that there was a possibility of a silent killer present! Eggs can kill you through cholesterol or salmonella poisoning! During years of blissful ignorance I ate bacon and eggs without fear! Now I can't even eat

breakfast without being confronted by fear of a silent killer being present!

Now that I have begun cutting the fat, and cholesterol from my diet, I learn that certain kinds of cholesterol are actually good for us!

I tried eating a little oat bran, some bran muffins and fruit-fiber cereals, yet I'm told their not all they were cracked up to be!

Sugar has been labeled a killer so we started using substitute sweeteners just in time to learn they cause cancer in laboratory rats! We are not sure what effect it has on the rats in the free world!

Now it seems antacids contain aluminum and of course it is suspected of causing Alzheimer's disease!

Beef has cancer causing hormone additives, chicken contains salmonella poisoning, fish contains iodine, fruit is dangerous because of cancer-causing spray!

For years the experts told us that junk food would kill us, but now they tell us that many of them are actually full of nutrients!

If one spends his/her life listening to the fear mongers one would become afraid to even open the refrigerator! It is as if the cold fingers of death are reaching out of the thing saying *"Preservatives; cholesterol; chemicals; substitutes; additives; we're all here for one reason; to do you in!"*

Some folks choose to live their lives so petrified by fear that they cannot even leave the safety of their own home!

I don't know the specific reason for the fear you may be experiencing today but I can tell you that you can charge it to the cross and let the blood settle it! Psalms 56:1-4 (KJV) ***"Be merciful unto me, O God: for***

man would swallow me up; he fighting daily oppresseth me. (2) Mine enemies would daily swallow me up: for they be many that fight against me, O thou most High. (3) What time I am afraid, I will trust in thee. (4) In God I will praise His Word, in God I have put my trust; I will not fear what flesh can do unto me."

The reason the Psalmist could make such a bold statement as ***"I will not fear,"*** is not because he didn't have any trouble, but because he had cast his fear on God, and placed his confidence in Him as his deliverer!

In fact when David was fleeing from Absalom his son, which was no doubt the very worst time in his life, David said, Psalms 3:1-6 (KJV) ***"LORD how are they increased that trouble me! Many are they that rise up against me. (2) Many there be which say of my soul, There is no help for him in God. Selah. (3) But thou, O LORD, art a shield for me; my glory, and the lifter up of mine head. (4) I cried unto the LORD with my voice, and he heard me out of his hold hill. Selah. (5) I laid me down and slept; I awaked; for the LORD sustained me. (6) I will not be afraid of ten thousands of people, that have set themselves against me round about."***

When facing Goliath David said, ***"Let no man's heart fail because of him."*** (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)
We can charge our panic to the cross and let the blood settle it!

It is the business of the enemy of our soul to continually cause turmoil and upheaval in our lives. He attempts to do this with great consistency so that we can never quite gain enough confidence in our own standing and relationship with the Lord, that we can acquire peace in spite of the storm, problem, or circumstance! Hebrews 10:35-36 (KJV) ***"Cast not away therefore your confidence, which hat great recompense of reward. (36) For ye have need of patience, that, after ye have done the will of God, ye might receive the promise."***

When we are suffering from a lack of confidence we are more vulnerable then, than at any other time! **When we are facing times of fear we should: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- **Know who we are** (Heirs of God...)
- **Know whose we are** (It is He who has made us...)
- **Know where we are** (In the perfect center of His will...)
- **Know where we are going** (Heaven...)

If we find ourselves in a situation where our problems have gotten the best of us, and panic has set in, and we are suffering from a confidence crisis, that's where the Cross comes into play; we can charge it to the cross and let the blood settle it! His cross provides peace! Colossians 1:20 (KJV) *"And, having made peace through the blood of his cross, by him to reconcile all things unto himself; by him, I say, whether they be things in earth, or things in heaven."* **Notice peace is not only provided for, but his cross: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- **Makes peace** (Manufactures peace)
- **Makes peace nigh** (Places it within reach)
- **Preaches peace** (Proclaims or loudly announces)
- **Is peace** (Everything about the cross is peaceful)

If we are in turmoil and panic stricken what we need is another trip to Calvary's cross and allow its finished work to lift us from panic to peace and walk away a different person!

CONCLUSION:

Psalms 27:1-6 (KJV) *"The LORD is my light and my salvation; whom shall I fear? the LORD is the strength of my life; of whom shall I be afraid? (2) When the wicked, even mine enemies and my foes, came upon me to eat up my flesh, they stumbled and fell. (3) Though an host should encamp against me, my heart shall not fear; though war should rise against me, in this will I be confident. (4) One thing have I desired of the LORD, that will I seek after; that I may dwell in the house of the*

LORD all the days of my life, to behold the beauty of the LORD, and to inquire in his temple. (5) For in the time of trouble he shall hide me in his pavilion: in the secret of his tabernacle shall he hide me; he shall set me up upon a rock. (6) And now shall mine head be lifted up above mine enemies round about me: therefore will I offer in his tabernacle sacrifices of joy; I will sing, yea, I will sing praises unto the LORD.

David said:

- I will not fear
- I will not be afraid
- I will be confident
- I will dwell in His house
- I will be hid by Him
- I will be hid in His pavilion
- I will have Joy
- I will sing
- I will praise

Psalms 23 ***“Yea though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death...” “Surely goodness and mercy shall follow me...”***

How could David be so confident that he would be able to follow through on his statements concerning calm behavior in the middle of devastating dilemmas? Dr. Luke records the prophecy of Zacharias, which put it like this, Luke 1:78-79 (KJV) ***“Through the tender mercy of our God; whereby the dayspring from on high hath visited us, (79) To give light to them that sit in darkness and in the shadow of death, to guide our feet into the way (Lifestyle) of peace.”***

Let us charge our panic to the cross and allow the finished work of the savior to provide peace in turbulent situations!

SONG: *“I Know The Peace Speaker”*

It was such a lovely day
The sun was shining bright

The gentle wind was blowing my way
Not a storm cloud in sight
Then suddenly without warning
A storm surrounded my life
but even in the storm
I can feel a calm
And here's the reason why.

I know the peace speaker
I know him by name
I know the peace speaker
he controls the winds and rain
When he says "peace be still"
they have to obey
I'm glad I know the peace speaker
I know him by name

There's never been another man
With the power of this friend
By simply saying "peace be still"
He controls the strongest waves
And that's why I never worry
When storm clouds come my way
I know that He is near
To drive away my fears
And I can smile and say.

"Peace, Peace, wonderful Peace"